Mountain Climbing Accidents

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ABSTRACT

This project is an accumulation and application of what Professor J Linares taught in Intro to Database Systems. It uses MySQL and three datasets to organize large amounts of data for climbers, helping them plan and be safer on their journey. The data is centered around deaths that have occurred on mountains worldwide and contains details like when, where, and how they died. The data is imported and organized in MySQL to make research much easier for climbers and lets the databases connect to make it unified.

I. Introduction

Many people enjoy mountain climbing, whether small-time mountains or big ones like Mount Everest. Many come unprepared and without the knowledge necessary to complete the climb or when to not even attempt it. There is no website or accurate way to know when you should go and climb specific mountains and when the conditions will be right for the safest climb. Our dataset will show when the most fatalities happened, what mountain, and a trend in how they died. We want to give climbers an idea of when they shouldn't go, what to look out for, if a specific mountain may be outside their skill range, and what to be mindful of during their climb. All this info will be accessible from one spot, giving an easier way to determine what mountains are safe to climb at the time and what to prepare for. Our data set has over 599 causes of death and 654 mountains, so there will be broad or more specific options to fit any climber's needs.

II. Literature Review

As mountain climbing became popular since the 1960s, accidents from mountain climbing have progressed as the sport became more popular. As more of these accidents happen, it is important to collect data on them so people can analyze critical causes of mountain climbing accidents and prepare for them in order to prevent them. There are many important factors to consider when analyzing these accidents, including but not limited to: season, weather, and characteristics of the mountain. For example, the majority of mountain climbing accidents are caused by falling. However, it is important to consider what caused the falling. Is the mountain prone to avalanches? Did the climbers have the adequate safety equipment? These factors are important in a database about mountain climbing accidents that can be useful for mountain climbing preparation and safety. Many databases only cover a small sample of information to inform climbers better, and usually only focus on one mountain per database. So we will make this project unique by covering multiple mountains, the season, the date, and the specific mountain on which the fatality happened.

III. METHODOLOGY

Using MySQL, we integrated data from the mountain clmbing accidents dataset, list of mountains dataset, and countries population dataset. These datasets were updated through Excel to meet the project's needs and clear unrecognized characters for MySQL.

IV. CONCLUSION

This data helps climbers know when the most deaths have occurred, the most common way they have died, and the countries with the most deaths, all of which include the mountain on which the accident took place. This will help climbers know when the best conditions are and what they should be looking out for to keep themselves safe. The dates given are also precise, so weather data from other websites can be used to help climbers understand more of what happened.

V. REFERENCES

Rauch, Simon, et al. "Climbing Accidents—Prospective Data Analysis from the International Alpine Trauma Registry and Systematic Review of the Literature." *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, vol. 17, no. 1, 27 Dec. 2019, p. 203, www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6981967/, https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph17010203.